Artwork Approval Checklist

Check the dieline version, bleed, safe zones, colors, fonts, barcodes, copy, special finishes and final approved proof version.

Applicable Scope
Use before approving packaging artwork or releasing the confirmed files for production review.

Check Method
Review the final artwork against the confirmed dieline and supplier requirements. Compare the proof with the files you intend to approve.

Required Documents
Confirmed dieline, editable artwork or production PDF, linked images and fonts where needed, color references and final proof.

1. Dieline & Layout

- ☐ **Dieline version**
  Match the dieline filename, version and dimensions with the confirmed packaging structure.
- ☐ **Bleed**
  Check artwork extends to the required bleed boundary in the confirmed dieline or supplier instructions.
- ☐ **Safe zones**
  Keep essential copy and graphics inside the confirmed safe zones and clear of structural or non-printable areas.

2. Color

- ☐ **Colors**
  Check the requested color mode, spot-color references and proof against the agreed printing requirements.

3. Fonts, Copy & Barcodes

- ☐ **Fonts**
  Check for missing or substituted fonts and confirm the agreed font handoff or outlining method.
- ☐ **Barcodes**
  Check the supplied barcode, placement and readability using the agreed verification method.
- ☐ **Copy**
  Review spelling, product details, labels and the exact copy that is being approved.

4. Special Finishes

- ☐ **Special finishes**
  Check finish positions and separately identified layers against the agreed process and proof.

5. Final Approval

- ☐ **Final approved proof version**
  Confirm the final file and proof version, approval record and any outstanding revisions before release.

Checking items records preparation only. It is not a test report, certification or final approval. Use the criteria agreed for your project.

Related resources
Artwork Preparation
Packaging Guides